



Maasai man, Tanzania

The Maasai live in Kenya and Tanzania and are well known for their distinctive dress of brightly coloured, usually red, fabrics that are draped around the body.



Jordanian woman in traditional dress

This woman wears a typical Muslim *hijab* and a *thawb*. Dress in Jordan is distinctive for its elaborate use of *embroidery*, with each village having its own designs.

SPUN SILK Yarn made from waste *silk* fibre, used to make *fabrics*, *embroidery silk*, and ribbons.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷

STACKED HEEL A heel made by stacking thin layers of wood, leather, or other material, or a heel designed to look as if it has been made in this way.

17TH CENTURY ▷

STAND COLLAR An upright collar.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.155, 399, 439

STAND-FALL COLLAR A collar that is folded over, with the inner upright part called the “stand” and the downturned part called the “cape”.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.439

STARCH A substance used to smooth and stiffen fabrics; most types are extracts from plants.

14TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.124

STAYS The precursor of the *corset*: a tight undergarment for women, stiffened with *whalebone*, worn to give a fashionable shape.

17TH–18TH CENTURY: SEE P.139

STILETTO HEELS High, narrow heels, often reinforced with steel, seen on women’s shoes.

1954 ▷: SEE PP.426–7

STIRRUP PANTS Close-fitting, stretchy trousers for women, with the fabric forming a loop under the foot; see also *Ski pants*.

STOLA A full-length, sleeveless dress placed over the *tunica* and under the *palla*, and secured by brooches and a belt; worn by married Roman women.

c.100BCE–300CE: SEE PP.34–7

STOLE A wide shawl or wrap of fur or luxury fabric, worn around the shoulders by women.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.170, 236

STOMACHER A stiff, triangular panel, often heavily *embroidered*, worn over the chest and stomach, at the front of an open *bodice*.

15TH–18TH CENTURY: SEE PP.138–9, 145, 432–3

STONE-WASHING A technique in which a fabric such as *denim* is artificially aged or distressed.

20TH CENTURY

STRAIGHT ENGLISH SKIRT A straight-sided, flat-fronted skirt with *gathers* at the back to give fullness.

1890: SEE P.457

STRAIGHT TROUSERS Trousers in which the legs are the same width from hip to ankle.

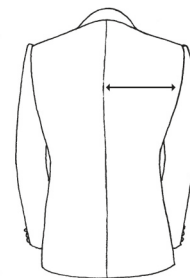
19TH CENTURY ▷

STREET STYLE A term for styles created by young people for themselves and taken up by fashion designers, for example, *mod style*.

1960s ▷: SEE PP.404–5

STYLE WIDTH

A tailoring term for the horizontal measurement from the centre back seam of a coat to the armhole.



SUEDE Tanned leather with the flesh side treated to give a *nap*, and used with the napped side outwards.

19TH CENTURY ▷

SUGARLOAF HAT A hat with a high, conical crown and a broad brim, worn by both men and women.

1640s: SEE PP.73, 123, 159

SUIT An outfit usually comprising a *jacket* with trousers or a skirt of the same material, worn as business or formal wear; see also *Lounge suit*.

19TH CENTURY ▷

SUIT OF APPAREL A man’s outfit based on *doublet* and *hose*.

16TH–17TH CENTURY: SEE PP.90–91

SUMPTUARY LEGISLATION Laws governing garments and fabrics to be worn by (or forbidden for) specific levels of society, such as the law that only royalty could wear *ermine*.

MEDIEVAL–17TH CENTURY

SUPPORTASSE A decorated wire framework worn at the back of the neck to support a *ruff* or a *band*; see also *Pickadil*, *Rebato*, *Underpropper*.

c.1550–1650: SEE P.99

SWAGGER COAT A loose top coat for women that flares from the shoulders.

20TH CENTURY ▷

SWALLOWTAIL A man’s *tail coat* in which the front part reaches to the waist and the back has knee-length *tails*; still worn for highly formal (“white tie”) events.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.262–3

SWEATER See *Jumper*.

SWEETHEART NECKLINE On women’s dresses, a wide neckline forming a curved V at the front, with the point at the centre of the bust.

20TH CENTURY: SEE PP.326, 451

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TABARD (a) A short overgarment like a *tunic*, originally worn by peasants, or a more elaborate garment worn by a knight over armour, and bearing the knight’s coat of arms; (b) a *jerkin* worn by a royal officer of arms, and emblazoned with the arms of the sovereign; (c) a loose, short-sleeved or open-sided top for women, especially one used as a beach-robe; (d) an open-sided protective garment worn by cleaners and other uniformed workers.

ANTIQUITY ▷: SEE PP.39, 168

TABBY A thick, glossy *taffeta* with a watered surface (see *Watered fabrics*) giving a striped appearance.

17TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

TABI Traditional Japanese ankle socks, with thick soles and a division between the big toe and the other toes so they can be worn with shoes with a strap between the toes.

SEE P.459